

Why Your LinkedIn Profile Isn't Getting You Calls

A LinkedIn Audit Checklist by Lodestar

LinkedIn is your 24/7 recruiter. When it works, opportunities come to you. When it doesn't, you're invisible. Here's exactly what to fix — in order of impact.

VISIBILITY

The Basics Recruiters Filter On

Profile Photo

A professional photo increases profile views by 21x. Good lighting, clean background, genuine expression. No sunglasses, no group crops.

→ *Head and shoulders, facing camera, plain or blurred background.*

Custom URL

Fix your URL from the default gibberish to linkedin.com/in/yourname. It looks professional and belongs on your CV.

→ *Settings > Edit public profile > Edit URL (top right).*

Open to Work

Set it to 'Recruiters only' if currently employed. It increases recruiter contact by 40% without broadcasting to your employer.

→ *Profile photo > Open to > Finding a new job.*

POSITIONING

What Recruiters Read in the First 10 Seconds

Headline

Your headline is not your job title — it's your value proposition. 'Product Manager | Fintech & Logistics | 0-to-1 Products' is searchable. 'Product Manager' is not.

→ *Role + industry/specialization + one differentiator.*

About Section

This is your pitch. Not a list of skills — a narrative. Who you are, what you've delivered, what you're looking for. First 2 lines must hook before the 'see more' cut.

→ *Write in first person. End with a clear call to action.*

Banner Image

The default blue banner signals neglect. Replace it with something that reflects your brand — even a plain dark background beats the default.

→ *1584 x 396px. Use Canva — free, takes 5 minutes.*

EXPERIENCE

Where Most Profiles Fail

Every Role Has a Description

A job title with no bullets is a missed opportunity. Recruiters can't assess fit without context. 3–5 bullet points per role minimum.

→ *Start every bullet with an action verb: Led, Launched, Reduced, Built, Delivered.*

Quantify at Least One Bullet Per Role

Numbers make you memorable. 'Reduced onboarding time by ~35%' beats 'Improved onboarding process' every time. Even estimates count.

→ *Think: time saved, money managed, team size, user growth, revenue impact.*

Most Recent Role is Fully Built Out

Recruiters spend 80% of their time on your last 2 roles. Make sure your current or most recent role tells a complete, compelling story with 5+ bullets.

→ *Aim for at least 2 quantified results in your top role.*

CREDIBILITY

What Makes Recruiters Trust You

Skills Section

Add the top 5 skills from your target job descriptions. LinkedIn's algorithm uses skills for search ranking. Ask 3 people to endorse your top skills.

→ *Prioritize hard skills over soft skills in your top 3.*

Recommendations

One genuine recommendation from a manager or senior colleague is worth more than 50 endorsements. Ask 2–3 people you've worked closely with.

→ *Make it easy — offer to draft a starting point for them.*

Activity and Posts

Profiles that post or engage regularly rank higher in recruiter searches. One thoughtful post per week about your field is enough to stay visible.

→ *Comment on posts in your industry. It costs nothing and builds your network.*

LODESTAR

Find your direction. Own your story.

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